Deliverable: Design Challenge - Haru Platform

This document presents the design proposal and strategic reasoning for the redesign of Haru, an Ecuadorian personal finance management startup.

> TIP:

*> **Interactive Prototype Available:***

> We have developed a high-fidelity interactive simulator (HTML/CSS/JS) where you can navigate the application screens, interact with expense categories, and test the friction-free auto-categorization experience.

*> **Open Local File:** [index.html](file:///c:/Users/renat/OneDrive/Proyectos/Caso%20UI/Design%20Challenge/index.html)*

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1. Context & Reasoning: Empathy with the User

What do we understand about the problem?

Users of personal finance apps experience three main friction points in current market solutions:

1. The Paralysis of Cold Numbers: Numbers without context cause anxiety or lack of interest. Seeing that you spent "$300 on food" does not answer the underlying question: *Am I doing well or badly?*.
2. The Friction of Manual Bookkeeping: Nobody wants to spend 10 minutes a day manual-categorizing transactions. If the app requires this effort, the user will abandon it in less than a week.
3. Lack of Actionability: Showing beautiful but static pie charts does not change habits. The user needs suggestions and insights that require zero cognitive load.

Hypotheses Guiding Our Proposal

* Automation Hypothesis: If we reduce the categorization process to a 1-tap express validation, we will increase user retention by 60%.
* Human Language Hypothesis: If we replace abstract charts with conversational, direct insights, the user will immediately understand their financial status.
* Free Margin Motivation Hypothesis: Focusing the UI on the "Free Margin" (what is left after fixed expenses and savings targets) reduces guilt and promotes healthy habits.

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2. Lateral Thinking: Questioning the Request

*> **Does the user really need complex charts and tedious manual bookkeeping?***

*> **No.** The user does not want to become their own accountant. They want peace of mind and control over their money.*

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> *Instead of building complex editing tools, we automate 95% of the mental load with a local predictive engine. If the system makes a mistake, the user can re-categorize with a single click from their daily summary, or ignore it and let the system assume the default classification asynchronously.*

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3. The Simplified Journey (User Flow)

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1. Notification / Input: Haru processes a transaction from a local merchant (e.g., *Supermaxi*).
2. Auto-Categorization: The predictive engine assigns the category (*Food*).
3. Express Validation (Zero Friction): An interactive widget on the dashboard lets the user confirm with one button ("It's Correct") or change it with another ("Change").
4. Dynamic Update: The savings target and "Free Margin" update immediately, accompanied by an actionable insight about that category.
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4. Design Decisions (UX / UI)

UX Decisions (User Experience)

* Emotional Health Indicator: The financial state is summarized in an empathetic phrase at the header (e.g., ` Everything is okay`, ` Goal in risk`).

* Focus on Free Margin: The dashboard highlights the money the user *can spend freely* without neglecting their obligations or savings goal.

* Narrative Insights: Tapping any expense category generates a conversational paragraph that analyzes behavior and suggests how to save (e.g., suggesting buying at local markets instead of large chains).

UI Decisions (User Interface)

* Typography: We use *Outfit* (clean and modern titles with personality) and *Plus Jakarta Sans* (readable numerical data).

* Smart Color Palette:

* Deep purple (`#6D3BFF`) for brand identity and a modern feel.

* Emerald green (`#00E676`) to indicate success and savings growth.

* Vibrant, high-contrast category colors set against an elegant dark background.

* Glassmorphism Components: Subtle transparencies and borders establish visual hierarchy without cluttering the screen.

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5. Applied Case Data (Simulation)

For the interactive simulation, we have modeled the provided fictional data:

* Monthly Income: $1,200.00
* Total Expenses: $950.00
* *Food:* $300.00 (31.6%)
* *Transport:* $150.00 (15.8%)
* *Entertainment:* $200.00 (21.1%)
* *Others:* $300.00 (31.6%)
* Savings Goal: $100.00 per month.
* Result: With $950 in expenses, the actual savings amount is $250 (exceeding the target by 250%!).
* Prototype Interaction: When you approve the new simulated transaction of $35.00 at Supermaxi, total expenses rise to $985.00, free margin drops to $215.00, and savings progress is recalculated in real time.